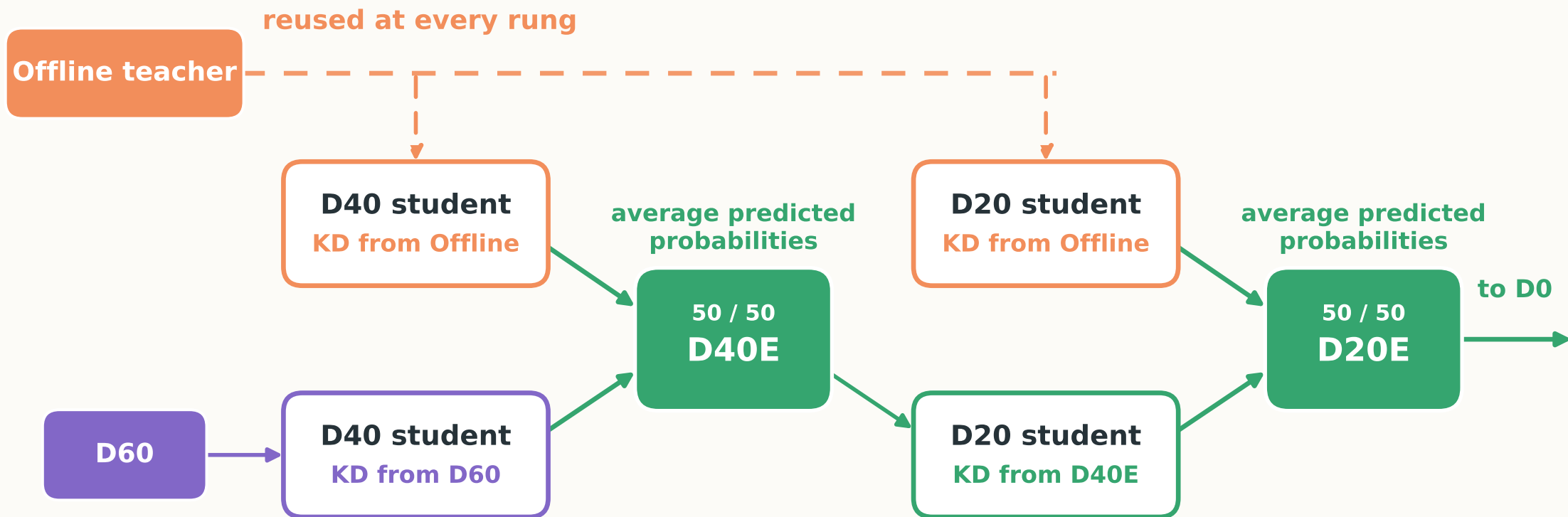


4. Ensembling each D-ladder step



At each D rung: same target inputs, separate cold-start students; only the KD teacher changes.

E = the 50/50 probability ensemble passed forward as the next local teacher.